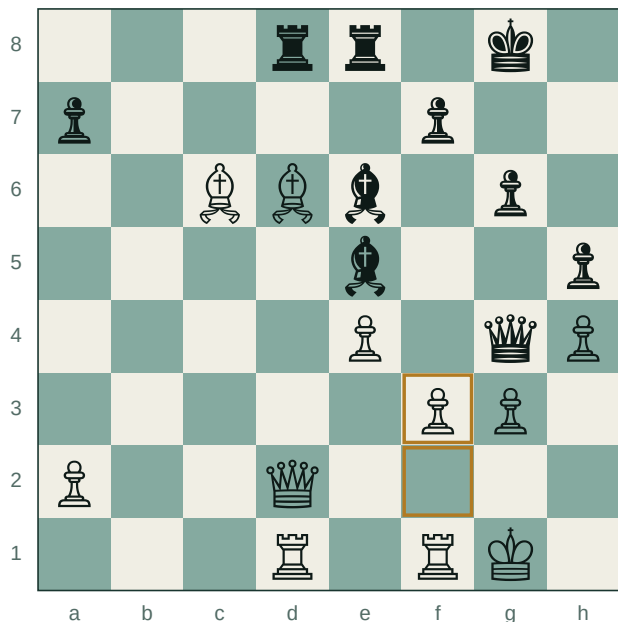


Deflection tactics: Black, move 23

Deflection tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 23.f3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

23...Qxg3+ 24. Qg2 Bxd6 25. Qxg3 Bxg3 26. Bxe8 Rxe8

23...Qxg3+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. The move also takes the pawn on g3. Recorded reply: **24.Qg2**.

24...Bxd6 The bishop captures the bishop on d6. Recorded reply: **25.Qxg3**.

25...Bxg3 The bishop captures the queen on g3. The changed line means the rook on d8 attacks the rook on d1. Recorded reply: **26.Bxe8**.

26...Rxe8 The rook captures the bishop on e8.

At the end, nominal material is White 14 / Black 15 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +2. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +2:** the balance goes from -1 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on g1. Absolute pin: pawn on g3.